NOVEMBER 4 – 12, 2026 · FIRST TRIP

Nine days in *Japan.*

Tokyo, one night in the Niigata mountains, one night at Lake Kawaguchiko. Times are Japan Standard Time. Add 10 minutes inside Shinjuku, Tokyo, and Shibuya stations.

Narita — Wed 4
Ueno — 3 nights
Niigata — Sat 7
Akihabara — Sun 8
Fuji — Mon 9
Shinjuku — 2 nights
Narita — Thu 12

WED 4 · DAY 1
Land in Ueno
Skyliner, 41 min. Miura Misaki sushi.

THU 5 · DAY 2
Asakusa, then Sky
Street sunset 16:42. Roof at 18:20.

FRI 6 · DAY 3
Old Tokyo houses
Museum, Nakano, Harajuku, monja.

SAT 7 · DAY 4
Koi, then onsen
Backpack only. Izumiya kaiseki.

SUN 8 · DAY 5
Owls at 14:00
Toki around 10:19. Then Akihabara.

MON 9 · DAY 6
Lake Kawaguchiko
Fuji Excursion 09:30. Hōtō lunch.

TUE 10 · DAY 7
Red pagoda
398 steps. Back on the 14:08.

WED 11 · DAY 8
Skytree & aquarium
Penguins at 13:30. Tempura at 19:00.

THU 12 · DAY 9
Fly at 17:30
N'EX by 13:45. Be at Narita 14:30.

Lock these in.

TICKETS & TABLES

BOOKED · THURSDAY NOV 5

Shibuya Sky
enter 18:20

Night view, not sunset. Sunset is 16:42, from the street. Stay until you leave for dinner at 19:40. No re-entry. No suitcase.

BOOKED · SUNDAY NOV 8

Akiba Fukurou
session 14:00

Be outside at 13:40. 67 Kanda Neribeicho, 3 minutes from JR Akihabara Central Gate. About one hour. They do not serve a meal.

☐ THU 5 · 20:00

Ushigoro Kan

A5 wagyu, Ebisu. Order tongue, kalbi, and a lean cut. Tabelog, or 03-5725-2929 at 15:00–16:30 Japan time. About ¥10,000–15,000.

☐ FRI 6 · 19:30

Iroha Honten

Monjayaki, not okonomiyaki. Sakura-ebi plus a seafood mix. reserve.restaurant-iroha.com or 03-3531-1668. About ¥4,000–6,000.

☐ WED 11 · 19:00

Tsunahachi

Tempura set or tendon. The website request is not held until they call you back. Or 03-3352-1012. Not same-day. About ¥4,000–8,000.

Sunday train: book the 10:19 Toki, Nagaoka → Ueno.

About 1 hour 25–35 minutes, reserved seat near ¥9,320. Taxi from the ryokan at 9:15. The 10:45 still works. An 11:55 gets you to Ueno around 13:20 and misses a calm 14:00 owl check-in. There is no 11:00 train that arrives at 12:35.

NOV 4–7

MIMARU Ueno North
7-14-4 Ueno · suitcases stay

NOV 7

Izumiya, Yomogihira
Backpack only. Forward the big bags in the morning.

NOV 8

MIMARU Inaricho
Bags should already be in the room.

NOV 9

Maruei, Kawaguchiko
Take the suitcases. Taxi from the station.

NOV 10–12

MIMARU Shinjuku West
Last two nights. Unpack fully.

ALSO BOOK

Sumida Aquarium Nov 11
Fuji Excursion 9:30 out, 14:08 back. N'EX home.

Call before you fly.

15:00–16:30 in Japan.

That is 1:00–2:30 AM US Eastern in November. Awake window: 8:30–9:30 PM Eastern, which is 10:30–11:30 AM the next morning in Tokyo. Do not call during dinner, 18:00–21:00 Japan time.

Use the 03 number.

050 numbers often fail from the United States. Web forms work at any hour. Conveyor sushi does not take a reservation — those shops are on the next page.

THU NOV 5 · 20:00 · RESERVE

¥10,000–15,000

Ushigoro Kan, Ebisu

A5 black wagyu, cut small so you can taste several pieces. Shoes off, sunken seats, two-hour table. Weekdays 17:00–23:30.

Order tongue, kalbi, and a lean cut. Or the seasonal course and let them grill. Sake if you want a drink.

Book Tabelog any hour, or **03-5725-2929**. Upgrade if a table appears: Ebisu Yoroniku.

https://www.tripadvisor.com/Restaurant_Review-g1066456-d6622710-Reviews-Ushigoro_Kan_Ebisu-Shibuya_Tokyo_Tokyo_Prefecture_Kanto.html

FRI NOV 6 · 19:30 · RESERVE

¥4,000–6,000

Iroha Honten, Tsukishima

Monjayaki since 1955. A thin, runny batter cooked on the iron plate at your table. Not the thick Osaka pancake. Staff will cook it or coach you. 2F, 3-4-5 Tsukishima.

Order sakura-ebi monja, plus one seafood mix.

Book reserve.restaurant-iroha.com, or **03-3531-1668**. Backup: Monja Okame, same neighborhood.

https://www.tripadvisor.com/Restaurant_Review-g14129637-d3758256-Reviews-Iroha_Honten-Tsukishima_Chuo_Tokyo_Tokyo_Prefecture_Kanto.html

WED NOV 11 · 19:00 · RESERVE

¥4,000–8,000

Tsunahachi Sohonten, Shinjuku

Edomae tempura since 1924. Light batter, shrimp, seasonal vegetables, tentsuyu or salt. A short walk from MIMARU Shinjuku West.

Order the tendon or the chef's set. Not one prawn.

Book tunahachi.co.jp/reservation is only a request until they call you back. Or **03-3352-1012**. Not same-day. They stop seating around 20:00.

https://www.tripadvisor.com/Restaurant_Review-g14133707-d1660271-Reviews-Shinjuku_Tsunahachi_Sohonten-Shinjuku_3_Chome_Shinjuku_Tokyo_Tokyo_Prefect.html

TUE NOV 10 · 19:30 · ONLY IF HELD

Skip if you have no table

Bird Land, Ginza

Michelin yakitori, Okukuji Shamo. B1, 4-2-15 Ginza, exit C6. Closed Sunday and Monday. Nov 10 is Tuesday, so they are open. Dinner 17:00–22:00.

Order the omakase skewer course. **Book** ginza-birdland.sakura.ne.jp/reserve.html or **03-5250-1081** on a day they are open. Same-day cancel is ¥11,000 a person. No table means Sushi Zanmai that night.

Walk in. Don’t call.

SHOW UP HUNGRY

WED 4 ~19:45 · SUN 8 ~18:15

Miura Misaki, Ueno

Tuna wholesaler, about 19 counter seats, 6-12-14 Ueno. No reservations. Suitcases stay in a locker. A wait at 18:00–20:00 is normal.

Order the heaped chūtoro or negitoro gunkan, the Misaki tuna assortment, and aburi toro. On Sunday, order what you skipped.

https://www.tripadvisor.com/Restaurant_Review-g14134274-d3760771-Reviews-Magurodonya_Miura_Misakiko_Ueno-Ueno_Taito_Tokyo_Tokyo_Prefecture_Kanto.html

THU 5 · 15:10 · NO BOOKING

Uobei, Dōgenzaka

Booths, English touchscreen, plates on a little track. This is the sushi meal. Dinner is the yakiniku.

Order aburi salmon and a shrimp tempura roll.

https://www.tripadvisor.com/Restaurant_Review-g1066456-d3871559-Reviews-Uobei_Shibuya_Dogenzaka-Shibuya_Tokyo_Tokyo_Prefecture_Kanto.html

MON 9 · 12:00 · EXPECT A LINE

Hōtō Fudō, Ekimae

The white cloud building at 3631-2 Funatsu, by Kawaguchiko Station. Not the Minami branch. One bowl is lunch.

Order hōtō: flat noodles, miso, pumpkin, mountain vegetables.

https://www.tripadvisor.com/Restaurant_Review-g1165976-d1664155-Reviews-Hoto_Fudo_Kawaguchiko_Ekimae-Fujikawaguchiko_machi_Minamitsuru_gun_Yamanashi_Prefecture_Koshinetsu_Chubu.html

TUE 10 · 17:00 · TAKE A TICKET

A Happy Pancake, Ginza

Soufflé pancakes. Weekdays close about 19:30, so 17:00 is the window and 18:30 is late. A queue, not a phone reservation.

Order the plain one with butter and maple.

https://www.tripadvisor.com/Restaurant_Review-g14129573-d14192375-Reviews-A_Happy_Pancake_Ginza-Ginza_Chuo_Tokyo_Tokyo_Prefecture_Kanto.html

TUE 10 · AFTER PANCAKES · 24 HOURS

Sushi Zanmai Honten

4-11-9 Tsukiji, the main shop with the tuna figure. Reservations are not accepted. If the line is over 40 minutes, pick another counter on the block.

Order the otoro / chūtoro set. Counter seat if one is open.

https://www.tripadvisor.com/Restaurant_Review-g14129610-d3597142-Reviews-Sushizanmai_Honten-Tsukiji_Chuo_Tokyo_Tokyo_Prefecture_Kanto.html

THU 12 · 11:45 · LEAVE BY 13:00

Nemuro Hanamaru, KITTE 5F

Hokkaido fish, across from Tokyo Station’s Marunouchi south side. Not the basement. No reservations. The review page spells it “Nemuiro.”

Order off the menu: fatty tuna, salmon in white soy, hontaku.

https://www.tripadvisor.com/Restaurant_Review-g14129528-d5015864-Reviews-Nemuiro_Hanamaru_Kitte_Marunouchi-Marunouchi_Chiyoda_Tokyo_Tokyo_Prefecture_Kan.html

ALREADY IN THE ROOM RATE

Izumiya and Maruei

Kaiseki comes with the stay. At Izumiya, say yes if Murakami wagyu on a hot stone is on the menu. Tell them about the Sunday 9:15 taxi when you confirm the inn, not at dinner.

Ojiya lunch: Sushimasa if the shutter is up (Niigata rice). If not, station soba. Do not reserve it.

WED 11 LUNCH · SUN BACKUP

Solamachi, or Ganso Zushi

Under Skytree, eat a rice bowl or ramen. Tempura is Tsunahachi that night.

If you skip the second Miura visit, walk into Ganso Zushi at Manseibashi while you are still in Akihabara. No confirmed review page for that counter, so none is printed here.

01
WED

Land, walk, sushi.

Narita → Keisei-Ueno → Ameyoko. Suitcases come with you.

SLEEP
MIMARU Tokyo
Ueno North

15:40	**Land at Narita** Economy Plus, so you are off the plane early. Check the terminal on the boarding pass: 1, 2, or 3.
15:40–16:50	**Immigration, bags, customs** Plan on 60–90 minutes the first time. Longer if the hall is full.
16:50–17:15	**Phone, Suica, Skyliner seat** Turn on the eSIM or pick up pocket Wi-Fi. Charge a Suica with ¥5,000–10,000. Screenshot the Skyliner car and seat.
17:20–18:05	**Skyliner to Keisei-Ueno · 41 min** Not an hour. Trains every 20–40 minutes. Suitcases go in the racks at the end of the car. About ¥2,470.
18:05–18:25	**Walk to the hotel** 8–12 minutes from Keisei-Ueno toward the Iriya side. Follow the map pin, not a random “Ueno” sign.
18:25–19:00	**Check in and say three things** Saturday night is a backpack. Please forward the big suitcases to MIMARU Ueno Inaricho on Saturday morning. Ask what time they need them.
19:00	**Convenience-store dinner backup** Egg-salad sandwich, onigiri, milk bread. Fried chicken is Lawson Karaage-kun or FamilyMart Famichiki. 7-Eleven does not sell Famichiki.
19:45–21:15	**Sushirun 1 · Miura Misaki-kō** 8–12 minute walk into Ameyoko. About 19 seats. Walk in; a wait at this hour is normal. **Order** the heaped chūtoro or negitoro gunkan, the Misaki tuna assortment, and aburi toro. **Tripadvisor reviews**. If the list is past 30 minutes, Toriton nearby. Then sleep.

ATM Seven Bank inside 7-Eleven

Keep out passport for the front desk

Carry-on both battery packs, never in the checked bag

02
THU

Street sunset, roof at night.

Asakusa in the morning. Shibuya Sky is 18:20, after the sun is gone.

SLEEP
MIMARU Tokyo
Ueno North

09:20	**Ginza Line to Asakusa · 5–7 min** ¥180. Exit toward Kaminarimon. Red lantern, then Nakamise-dōri. Eat in this order: warm ningyō-yaki, strawberry daifuku, Asakusa Menchi, Kagetsudō melon pan. Then Sensō-ji and the pagoda.
12:35	**Same line straight to Shibuya** About 35 minutes on the train, 45–50 door to door. ¥250.
13:20–15:00	**Shibuya Parco, 6th floor** Nintendo Tokyo and Pokémon Center Shibuya. This is not the Skytree store. If they are handing out numbered tickets, take one or come back later.
15:10–16:10	**Sushirun 2 · Uobei, Dōgenzaka** 8–12 minutes from Parco. English screen, plates on the little tracks. No reservation. **Order** aburi salmon and a shrimp tempura roll. Tripadvisor reviews. Dinner is the beef.
16:15–17:45	**Sunset from the street. Sun sets 16:42.** Miyashita Park roof by 16:30. Then the scramble itself. Then MEGA Don Quijote on Center-gai for KitKats and small things.
18:20–19:40	**Shibuya Sky · ticketed entry** Be at the 14F gate by 17:50. Lit crossing, Skytree to the east. You can stay until about 22:30, but leave at 19:40. One exit. If wind closes the roof, the indoor gallery on 46 still opens.
20:00–22:00	**Ushigoro Kan, Ebisu · table held** One Yamanote stop, 2 minutes. A5 wagyu, shoes off, sunken seats, two-hour table. **Order** tongue, kalbi, and a lean cut, or the seasonal course. Book on Tabelog or call 03-5725-2929 at 15:00–16:30 Japan time. Tripadvisor reviews. Back to Ueno about 35 minutes.

TICKET
Shibuya Sky 18:20 is a night view. A day backpack is fine. A suitcase is not. Locker a stuffed pack at Shibuya Station first.

IF THE SHOPS ARE SLAMMED
Pokémon Center Skytree Town on Wednesday has different stock. Do not burn the sunset hour in a line.

03
FRI

Houses, then Harajuku.

West Tokyo in the morning. The owl café is not today.

SLEEP
MIMARU Tokyo
Ueno North

08:30 — **Leave after breakfast**
Yamanote to Shinjuku (~25 min), Chūō Rapid to Musashi-Koganei (~25 min). North exit, Seibu bus platform 2 or 3. Off at Koganei-kōen Nishi-guchi, 5-minute walk. Door to door 75–85 minutes.

09:45–14:15 — **Edo-Tokyo Open Air Architectural Museum**
Inside the park. November hours 9:30–16:30, last entry 16:00, ¥400. Go into the houses. Find Kodakara-yu, the old bath that fed the look of the one in Spirited Away. Lunch at the museum café around 13:00.

14:50–16:20 — **Nakano Broadway**
Bus back, then the Chūō line, about 20 minutes. Mandarake and vintage figures. A different pile from Akihabara, which is Sunday.

16:50–18:20 — **Harajuku, small bites only**
Chūō to Shinjuku, Yamanote to Harajuku, about 25 minutes total. One crêpe or takoyaki on Takeshita-dōri, then Cat Street. Dinner is a full meal.

19:30–21:15 — **Iroha Honten, Tsukishima · table held**
Yamanote to Yūrakuchō, then the subway, 35–40 minutes. Leave Harajuku at 18:20. Thin monja batter on the iron plate; staff cook it with you. **Order** sakura-ebi monja plus a seafood mix. Book at reserve.restaurant-iroha.com or call 03-3531-1668 at 15:00–16:30 Japan time. Tripadvisor reviews. Back to Ueno about 40 minutes. Pack the Niigata backpack tonight.

IF YOU ALREADY HOLD GHIBLI TICKETS
Do the museum in Mitaka this morning and skip the open-air park. Both want half a day. Nakano and Harajuku still fit after.

IF THE BUILDINGS GRAB YOU
Stay until 15:30 and drop Nakano, not Harajuku. Rain: the rooms are indoors, the paths are not. Nakano Broadway is the indoor swap.

04
SAT

Koi ponds, then the mountain bath.

The 40L is your only bag. Ojiya and the ryokan are different taxi rides from Nagaoka.

SLEEP
Yomogihira
Onsen Izumiya

07:00	**Backpack only** One spare outfit, sleep shirt, socks, mini toiletries, both batteries, charger, warm layer, cash, a plastic bag. Yukata and towels are at the inn. No second pair of shoes.
07:30	**Hand the suitcases to MIMARU** Forward them to MIMARU Tokyo Ueno Inaricho for Sunday. Get a receipt. They may arrive late morning, not at 8:00.
08:30	**Toki, Tokyo Station → Nagaoka** Ueno to Tokyo is 8–9 minutes. Ride about 1 hour 35–50. Reserved seat, roughly ¥9,000–11,000. Watch for the mountains after the long tunnel.
10:30–13:00	**Nishikigoi no Sato, Ojiya** Taxi 35–45 minutes is the calm way. Train to Ojiya is 20 minutes, then a bus. Wooden bridges, collector koi, feed them, then leave. This is the birthplace of colored koi.
13:00	**Sushirun 4 · lunch in Ojiya** Walk in. Sushimasa if the shutter is up: Niigata rice under local fish. If it is closed, station soba. Then a taxi to Izumiya, 40–55 minutes. Or return to Nagaoka East for the inn's shuttle, which runs about 13:30–17:00 and must be reserved.
15:00	**Check in. Book tomorrow's taxi.** You need to be at Nagaoka Station by 9:50 on Sunday. Ask them to have a taxi at 9:15. Then the alkaline outdoor bath. Shower first. No swimsuit.
19:00	**Kaiseki in the room** Included with the stay. Say yes if Murakami wagyu on the hot stone is on the menu. Futons appear while you eat. Sleep early.

Cash rural taxis still want it

App GO taxi, plus the inn's phone number

Tattoos ask before the public bath

05
SUN

Owls at two o’clock.

The early train is the whole trick. Akihabara happens after, not before.

SLEEP
MIMARU Tokyo
Ueno Inaricho

> **Leave Izumiya at 9:15. Toki around 10:19. Ueno around 11:45.**
> Backup train is about 10:45, and then lunch becomes a station bento. Do not take the train near 11:55.

07:45–08:45	**Breakfast at the inn** Still sit down for it. Checkout by 9:15 with the backpack only.
09:15–09:45	**Taxi to Nagaoka, east side** 25–30 minutes. Be at the Shinkansen gate with time to spare.
10:19	**Toki to Ueno · about 1h30** Reserved ordinary around ¥9,320. Get off at Ueno, not Tokyo.
11:50–13:15	**Drop the bag. Eat lunch.** MIMARU Inaricho is a 5–8 minute walk, or 3 minutes from Inaricho station. If the room is not ready, the desk holds the backpack. Do not unpack. Lunch in Ueno or Ameyoko. You will not be fed with the owls.
13:15	**One stop to Akihabara** Hibiya Line, about 3 minutes. Or walk 15.
13:40–14:50	**Akiba Fukurou · session 14:00** From the Central Gate, turn left. Yodobashi-Akiba is on your right. White building next to the vet. Slippers on. Staff handle the birds. About 50–60 minutes.
14:50–17:30	**Akihabara, unhurried** Super Potato, one GiGO crane floor, then Radio Kaikan or Mandarake. Yodobashi if you need a cable or a memory card.
18:15	**Sushirun 3 · Miura Misaki-kō again** JR back to Ueno in 3–6 minutes. Walk in. **Order** whichever of the heaped gunkan, tuna assortment, or aburi toro you skipped on Wednesday. Tripadvisor reviews. To skip a repeat, eat Ganso Zushi at Manseibashi at 17:30. Hotel is 5–10 minutes after. Open the forwarded suitcases and lay out Fuji clothes.

06
MON

Up to the lake.

Suitcases ride the Fuji Excursion. The hotel shuttle is too late for your arrival.

SLEEP
Maruei
Kawaguchiko

08:00	**Inaricho → Shinjuku with the big bags** Yamanote, 25–30 minutes, plus Shinjuku's walking. Follow signs for Limited Express Fuji Excursion, 富士回遊.
09:30–11:28	**Fuji Excursion to Kawaguchiko** About 1 hour 58 minutes. All seats reserved, about ¥4,200. Luggage space at the end of the car. Stops include Shimoyoshida, which you will use tomorrow.
11:30	**Taxi to Maruei · 8–10 min** The free shuttle usually starts at 14:00. Do not wait for it. Drop the bags even if the room is not ready.
12:00–13:45	**Hōtō Fudō · the cloud building** 3631-2 Funatsu, by the station. Walk in; lunch lines move. **Order** hōtō: flat noodles, miso, pumpkin, mountain vegetables. One bowl is the meal. Tripadvisor reviews.
14:00	**Lake edge, if the mountain is out** November is a good month. Afternoons still cloud over. Morning light tomorrow is the better bet.
15:00	**Check in** Lake-view room: beds plus tatami. Fill the private indoor bath. Rooftop deck for dusk. Sunset near the lake is about 16:40.
18:30	**Dinner in the hotel** Kaiseki, included. Stay in. Ask if they can hold bags in the morning while you climb to the pagoda.

Dawn look at Fuji before breakfast tomorrow

Train home target the 14:08, not a vague afternoon

07
TUE

The red pagoda, then Ginza.

Lock the suitcases. Climb light. Be on the 14:08 back to Shinjuku.

SLEEP
MIMARU Tokyo
Shinjuku West

07:30	**Breakfast and a Fuji check** Clearest light is early. Then checkout.
08:30–09:15	**Taxi to Kawaguchiko Station** 8–10 minutes. Big lockers fill on clear days. Staffed storage is the backup.
09:30–11:30	**Chūreitō Pagoda** Local train to Shimoyoshida, 5–10 minutes. Walk 10–15 minutes, then 398 stone steps. Red five stories, Fuji behind them if the sky allows. Water in the small bag only.
11:30–13:30	**Back, a snack, reclaim the bags** Station ramen or a convenience store. You want the luggage in hand before 13:30.
14:08–16:08	**Fuji Excursion to Shinjuku** About 2 hours. Backup is 14:58, arriving about 16:59. The 16:48 and 17:41 erase Ginza.
16:15	**MIMARU Shinjuku West** 10–15 minutes from the station with luggage. Unpack for two nights.
17:00–18:30	**Ginza · Sanrio, then pancakes** 20–30 minutes from Shinjuku. A Happy Pancake is a queue, and weekdays close about 19:30, so 17:00 is the window. **Order** the plain soufflé with butter and maple. Tripadvisor reviews.
19:00–20:30	**Sushirun 5 · Sushi Zanmai Honten** 4-11-9 Tsukiji, about 15 minutes on foot. Walk in, 24 hours. **Order** the otoro / chūtoro set and sit at the counter if a seat is open. Tripadvisor reviews. Past a 40-minute line, use another counter on the block. Bird Land only if you already hold 19:30 — omakase skewers, then skip Zanmai.

08
WED

Tower, jellyfish, tempura.

Bags stay in Shinjuku. No Kirby. The aquarium is in the same building.

SLEEP
MIMARU Tokyo
Shinjuku West

09:15–10:00	**Shinjuku → Tokyo Skytree** 35–50 minutes door to door. Follow Solamachi / Skytree Town signs, not a random tower exit.
10:00–11:30	**Tembo Deck, and Galleria if you bought it** Fast elevators, glass floor, the bay. A timed ticket skips the worst line. Door tickets still exist.
11:30–12:20	**Lunch in Solamachi** A normal restaurant on the food floors. Noodles or a rice set. Tempura is tonight.
12:30–14:00	**Sumida Aquarium, 5F and 6F** Entrance on 5F. Adult ¥2,700. About 90 minutes. Jellyfish and the big Ogasawara tank upstairs, then penguins and goldfish downstairs. Penguin feeding is 13:30. Tickets online or at the door machines.
14:00–17:00	**Floor 4, without Kirby** Pokémon Center Skytree Town, then Donguri Republic for Ghibli. Different stock from Shibuya. Plush goes in the tote.
17:40	**Leave for Shinjuku** 35–50 minutes. A claw machine is allowed only if it cannot make you late.
19:00–20:45	**Tsunahachi Sohonten · table held** Tempura since 1924, a short walk from the station and the hotel. **Order** the tendon or the chef's set. The web request is not held until they call you back; or call 03-3352-1012 at 15:00–16:30 Japan time. Not same-day. Tripadvisor reviews. Then pack. Tomorrow starts with a clock.

Ticket Sumida Aquarium, ¥2,700 | **Reservation** Tsunahachi, 19:00 | **Be there** penguin feeding at 13:30

09
THU

Last sushi, then the airport.

Flight at 17:30 from Narita. Be in the terminal at 14:30.

DEPART
Narita
17:30

THE MATH
N'EX from Tokyo Station is 53–60 minutes. Be on that train by 13:45. Character Street is a short lap, not a second shopping day.

IF THE MORNING SLIPS
Skip Character Street first. Be on a train toward Narita by 14:00 only if you accept a bad afternoon. Three hours at the airport is the rule.

09:30–10:30 — **Pack and check out of Shinjuku West**
Both batteries, meds, and one change of clothes ride in the backpack. Heavy plush goes in the checked suitcases. Fragile figures stay with you.

10:30–11:15 — **Shinjuku → Tokyo Station**
30–45 minutes with luggage. Do not budget the empty-handed time.

11:15–11:45 — **Lockers or the baggage desk**
Big cases go in. Passport, cards, and the daypack stay out. Coin lockers fill. Have the staffed counter as plan B.

11:45–13:00 — **Sushirun 6 · Nemuro Hanamaru**
KITTE Marunouchi, 5th floor, across from the Marunouchi south side. Walk in. **Order** off the menu: fatty tuna, salmon in white soy, and hontaku. **Tripadvisor reviews**. Be standing up at 13:00.

13:00–13:25 — **Tokyo Character Street**
First Avenue, one floor down. One focused lap. Buy only what still fits.

13:25–13:40 — **Bags, then the N'EX gate**
Reserved seats. Confirm Terminal 1 or Terminal 2·3 on the ticket.

13:45–14:45 — **Narita Express · 53–60 min**
Then check-in, security, and the gate. Be at the gate 30 minutes before 17:30.

Cleaner option Forward suitcases hotel → Narita the day before, if the cutoff allows

From Shinjuku direct N'EX is 80–90 min, so it leaves even earlier

What the 40L holds.

LEAVE THE LAPTOP AT HOME

Every city day, one-third full. Passport in an inner zip. One 10,000 mAh pack and a short cable. Jacket, compact umbrella, empty bottle, tissues, plasters, meds. A flat foldable tote for plush, so the pack stays for flat and fragile things. The second battery stays charging in the room, except on the travel days: Nov 4, 7, 8, 9, 10, and 12. Batteries never go in a checked suitcase.

Wed 4 · carry-on

Passport, meds, both batteries, cables, earbuds, one change of clothes, toothbrush, jacket, empty bottle, eye mask.

Thu 5 · light

Daily kit and a jacket for the roof. Eat the street food. Do not bag it.

Fri 6 · walking

Daily kit, tote, shoes you can wear for hours. The museum paths add up.

Sat–Sun morning · only bag

Outfit on your body, one spare, sleep shirt, underwear, socks, mini toiletries, both batteries, charger, warm layer, taxi cash.

Sun afternoon · shopping

Dump the ryokan clothes at Inaricho first. Games in the pack, plush in the tote.

Mon 9 · personal item

Daily kit, jacket, water, both batteries. Clothes stay in the suitcase on the train.

Tue 10 · stairs, then shops

Water, jacket, phone, battery, passport for the 398 steps. Sanrio bags come after the lockers.

Wed 11 · light

Daily kit and the tote. Pokémon and Ghibli plush go in the tote, not crammed under the jacket.

Thu 12 · carry-on again

Passport, meds, both batteries, cables, jacket, one outfit, headphones, fragile souvenirs. Heavy plush is checked.

HOP	TIME	
Narita → Ueno, Skyliner	41 min	Reserved
Ueno → Asakusa, Ginza Line	5–7 min	¥180
Asakusa → Shibuya, Ginza Line	35 min ride	~50 door to door
Ueno → museum	75–85 min	Bus at the end
Tokyo → Nagaoka	1h35–1h50	Sat morning
Nagaoka → Ueno	1h25–1h35	Sun ~10:19
Shinjuku → Kawaguchiko	~1h58	Mon 09:30
Kawaguchiko → Shinjuku	~2h	Tue 14:08
Tokyo → Narita, N'EX	53–60 min	Thu 13:45